

The Armed Forces Community



Why should I tell hospital staff?

Your Armed Forces background may be relevant to your health and care, even if you served for only a short time or left the Armed Forces many years ago.

With your agreement, staff can record your Armed Forces Community status on your patient record. This can help healthcare teams:

- understand whether a health condition or injury may be connected to military service;
- consider your experiences and circumstances when planning your care;
- make appropriate adjustments to support you during your hospital visit;
- connect or refer you to dedicated NHS Armed Forces services, local support and the Armed Forces Care Navigator, where appropriate.

Please speak to a member of staff if you are currently serving, a reservist, a veteran, or an immediate family member of someone who has served.

This can help clinicians understand possible service-related health needs and make appropriate referrals to dedicated services such as:

[Op COURAGE](#) – mental health support.

[Op FORTITUDE](#) – homeless veterans support.

[Op RESTORE](#) – injured veterans support.

[Op NOVA](#) – veterans justice system support.